

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 930

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dominican Sister of Peace Marina Gibbons, OP.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Dominican Sister of Peace Marina Gibbons, OP; and

WHEREAS, a native of Chicago, Illinois, Sister Marina devoted seventy-nine years of her life to religious vocation, education, and service as a member of the Dominican Sisters of Peace, leaving a legacy marked by intellectual rigor, compassion, and leadership; and

WHEREAS, Sister Marina Gibbons was a lifelong scholar, earning a Bachelor of Arts degree in English, Philosophy, and History from Manhattan College, a Master of Arts degree in Library Science from Rosary College, and a Doctor of Philosophy degree in English Literature from St. Louis University; and

WHEREAS, she ministered as a teacher at numerous institutions of learning, including Resurrection in Brooklyn, New York; Mount Trinity Academy in Watertown, Massachusetts; Rust College in Holly Springs, Mississippi; and Brooklyn College in Brooklyn, New York, sharing her love of literature and learning with generations of students; and

WHEREAS, Sister Marina provided distinguished educational leadership in Tennessee, serving as teacher, academic dean, and president of Siena College in Memphis and later as superintendent and president of St. Agnes/St. Dominic in Memphis, a role she assumed in 1978 and held for many years; and

WHEREAS, her service extended beyond the United States, and in 1994, Sister Marina Gibbons traveled to Vietnam, where she taught English in Ho Chi Minh City and surrounding areas, further reflecting her commitment to global education and cross-cultural engagement; and

WHEREAS, from 1996 to 2001, Sister Marina served as vice president and academic dean of St. Catharine College in St. Catharine, Kentucky, and from 2002 until the college's closing in 2016, she continued to serve generously as a volunteer in numerous capacities, while also providing community service at the St. Catharine Motherhouse; and

WHEREAS, Sister Marina Gibbons also served on the former leadership team of the Dominican Sisters of St. Catharine, offering wisdom and guidance shaped by decades of experience and faith-filled service; and

WHEREAS, in 2020, she moved to Sansbury Care Center, where she entered a final ministry of prayer and presence, continuing to serve others through quiet witness and devotion; and

WHEREAS, Sister Marina Gibbons is survived by several nieces and nephews and will be remembered with gratitude by countless students, colleagues, and communities whose lives were enriched by her leadership and care; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we remember the bountiful life of this exceptional human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Dominican Sister of Peace Marina Gibbons, OP, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Sister Marina Gibbons, OP.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.